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ECE 595 AI Ethics

Homework 2 – Ethics Autobiography

10/19/2026

Word Count: 830

My parents come from Spain, a majority Catholic country with the religion ingrained in its culture for the better part of the last two thousand years. I however do not go to mass regularly, I do not consider myself particularly Catholic if at all, but I acknowledge how much of a role the Catholic Church has had in my life. Most of my values I can somewhat tie to what my parents taught me about Jesus and what a good person was, someone who is patient, kind, and most of all forgiving. The most important values I hold are honesty and the value of looking inward and judging oneself before others, and I firmly believe these come in some way or another from the idea of emulating Jesus. That being said, there are of course values that I question and challenge. For one, I believe Catholics impose their world view onto other people too much. This is my main problem with organized religion, I personally do not believe that my values are undoubtedly the best or the only correct values that a person can have, and as such it is not my place to try to export them. This is in direct contact with the evangelizing component to most Chrisitan faiths, that it is one's role to share the religion and values with as many people as possible. My view on Catholicism and how it has impacted me is tricky, I feel culturally Catholic but not like I belong with the religion explicitly. There is a fine line, and I still go to church every now and then but there has been a disconnection growing for a while. To summarize everything, I feel like my Spanish Catholic upbringing has had a severely impactful role in my development as a person but at the same time, I have been floating away from the organized religion.

I believe the difference between right and wrong in electrical engineering and in personal lives is all about the gravity that actions in the tech sector have in comparison to personal decisions. While I believe in a less utilitarian approach to right and wrong for personal decisions, I think it shifts towards the best for most people when it comes to engineering decisions. For example, in my senior design project I am not concerned with how much power my smart home device consumes, and it is significant for a consumer electronic. If I were instead working on a major smart home device that will go in millions of homes, every watt I use is multiplied significantly and will have a noticeable effect on the power grid, which in itself has a lot more implications for the climate, cost of living, etc. I believe the biggest ethical dilemma that comes from electrical engineering is not knowing for certain the consequences that products and technologies can have, therein lies the true question. I could understand how two people with the same values could come to two separate conclusions about a technology given different ideas of how it would turn out, but it's almost always somewhat of a guess.

One tendency I have is my resilience to other people's comments, opinions, and intention, or in other words my stubbornness. I truly believe that most of the time I do what I want, whether it is ethical or not. This is an asset in my career as I can much better control what I do and question ethical dilemmas with my own values, not anyone else's. This strength could become a weakness if I am unable to listen to other people's advice and opinions and use them to form a well-rounded opinion. I think the right methodology for balancing being individualistic and staying true to yourself and working in a team and having the ability to listen to outside perspectives can at times be lost on me. It would be hard for someone to force me to do something I know is inherently wrong, the ethical wrongdoings would more likely come from my own somewhat flawed judgement of right, wrong, and right enough. My main area of ethical weakness is in my apathy, at times I cannot care about many outcomes of my behavior, and it has been a struggle to be more empathetic. This somewhat lines up with my stubbornness but this combination could lead me to make technical decisions that negatively impact people without being addressed correctly. To grow into a more empathetic engineer, I should always make a list of stakeholders in any product and do my best to humanize people and not treating them as numbers. It seems the unilateralistic approach I relate to has a way of dehumanizing people so I must balance it with a more deontologist approach. Everything is a balancing act and if I can avoid letting myself care only about my small portion of it, I believe I will be an ethical engineer who does make the world a better place.